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8.7 Practice Questions: Critical Reasoning

Each of the Critical Reasoning questions is based on a short argument, a set of statements, or a plan of action. For each question, select the best answer of the choices given.

Questions 613–672 — Difficulty: Easy

613. Arts advocate: Few universities require that students who are specializing in science and technology take many art courses. However, real progress in science and technology requires an element of creativity, which the arts foster. Thus, to help science and technology students succeed in their careers, universities should increase the number of art courses required for them.

Which of the following would, if true, most strengthen the argument above?

A. Universities required more art courses for science and technology students in the past.

B. Participation in art courses increases students' creative thinking in their science and technology courses.

C. More students who are interested in art would specialize in science and technology if the number of art courses required for those programs were increased.

D. Some of the most prominent scientists began their careers as artists.

E. Discussion of science and technology topics in art courses increases creative thinking among students in those courses.

614. Ramirez: The film industry claims that pirated DVDs, which are usually cheaper than legitimate DVDs and become available well before a film's official DVD release date, adversely affect its bottom line. But the industry should note what the spread of piracy indicates: consumers want lower prices and faster DVD releases. Lowering prices of DVDs and releasing them sooner would mitigate piracy's negative effect on film industry profits.

The argument above relies on which of the following assumptions?

A. Releasing legitimate DVDs earlier would not cause any reduction in the revenue the film industry receives from the films' theatrical release.

B. Some people who would otherwise purchase pirated DVDs would be willing to purchase legitimate DVDs if they were less expensive and released earlier than they are now.

C. The film industry will in the future be able to produce DVDs more cheaply than is currently the case.

D. Some current sellers of pirated DVDs would likely discontinue their businesses if legitimate DVDs were released faster and priced lower.

E. Current purchasers of pirated DVDs are aware that those DVDs are not authorized by the film industry.

615. Harunia Province has a relatively dry climate and is attracting a fast-growing population that has put increasing demands on its water supply. The two companies that supply water to the region have struggled to keep up with demand and still remain profitable. Yet now they are asking Harunian authorities to write residential water-use regulations that could reduce their revenues and restrict their future flexibility in supplying water profitably.

Which of the following would, if true, most logically help explain why the water-supply companies are asking the authorities to regulate residential water use?

A. The companies are planning large water-transportation and irrigation systems that require the approval of neighboring provinces.

B. The companies believe regulation is inevitable and that having it in place now will allow better planning and thus future profitability.

C. Few, if any, Harunian government officials have investments in the companies or serve on their boards of directors.

D. The companies believe that the population is not likely to continue to grow.

E. Long-term climate projections suggest that greater rainfall will eventually increase the amount of water available.

616. Loss of the Gocha mangrove forests has caused coastal erosion, reducing fish populations and requiring the

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616. Loss of the Gocha mangrove forests has caused coastal erosion, reducing fish populations and requiring the Gocha Fishing Cooperative (GFC) to partially fund dredging and new shore facilities. However, as part of its subsidiary businesses, the GFC has now invested in a program to replant significant parts of the coast with mangrove trees. Given income from a controlled harvest of wood with continuing replanting, the mangrove regeneration effort makes it more likely that the cooperative will increase its net income.

Which of the following, if true, would most strengthen the argument that mangrove replanting will increase the Gocha cooperative's net income?

A. The cost of dredging and shore facilities was shared with the local government.

B. The GFC will be able to hire local workers to assist with the mangrove replanting.

C. The GFC derives 10 percent of its revenue from salt-production facilities in an area previously cleared of mangroves.

D. Mangrove forests tend to increase the commercial fish populations in coastal fishing grounds.

E. A controlled harvesting of mangrove wood by the GFC would have little effect on coastal erosion.

617. Executives at the Fizzles Beverage Company plan to boost profits in Country X on their range of fruit-flavored drinks by introducing new flavors based on tropical fruits that are little known there. The executives reason that since the fruit drinks of other companies have none of these flavors, Fizzles will not have to compete for customers and thus will be able to sell the drinks at a higher price.

Which of the following, if true, presents the most serious potential weakness of the plan?

A. The new fruit drinks would be priced significantly higher than other Fizzles fruit drinks with more conventional flavors.

B. In a telephone survey, at least one of the consumers contacted said that they preferred many of the new flavors to all of the more familiar flavors.

C. To build widespread demand for the new flavors, Fizzles would have to launch an advertising campaign to familiarize consumers with them.

D. Consumers choosing among fruit-flavored drinks of different brands generally buy on the basis of name recognition and price rather than the specific fruit flavor.

E. Few consumers who are loyal to a specific brand of fruit-flavored drinks would willingly switch to another brand that costs more.

618. Economist: In 2015, the average per-person amount paid for goods and services purchased by consumers in Country X was the equivalent of $17,570 in United States dollars, just 30 percent of the corresponding figure of $58,566 for Country Y. Yet in 2015, there was already a substantial middle class in Country X that had discretionary income for middle-class consumer goods such as new vehicles, computers, or major household appliances, while a significant portion of the middle class in Country Y did not have sufficient income to purchase such items.

Which of the following, if true, most helps explain the discrepancy in the relationships described by the economist?

A. There are many consumer goods, such as household appliances, that are produced in Country X to be sold in the Country Y market.

B. The volume of trade between Country X and Country Y is increasing rapidly in both directions.

C. The economy of Country Y is recovering from a downturn that affected both Country Y and Country X.

D. Country X residents pay much less than their Country Y counterparts for housing, transportation, and child care.

E. In Country Y as well as in Country X, there are few assembly-line jobs in factories that pay a middle-class wage.

619. Neuroscientist: Memory evolved to help animals react appropriately to situations they encounter by drawing on the past experience of similar situations. But this does not require that animals perfectly recall every detail of all their experiences. Instead, to function well, memory should generalize from past experiences that are similar to the current one.

The neuroscientist's statements, if true, most strongly support which of the following conclusions?

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A. At least some animals perfectly recall every detail of at least some past experiences.

B. Perfectly recalling every detail of all their past experiences could help at least some animals react more appropriately than they otherwise would to new situations they encounter.

C. Generalizing from past experiences requires clear memories of most if not all the details of those experiences.

D. Recalling every detail of all past experiences would be incompatible with any ability to generalize from those experiences.

E. Animals can often react more appropriately than they otherwise would to situations they encounter if they draw on generalizations from past experiences of similar situations.

620. In Country X's last election, the Reform Party beat its main opponent, the Conservative Party, although pollsters, employing in-person interviews shortly before the vote, had projected a Conservative Party victory. Afterward, the pollsters determined that, unlike Conservative Party supporters, Reform Party supporters were less likely to express their party preference during in-person interviews than they were during telephone interviews. Therefore, using only telephone interviews instead would likely result in more accurate projections for the next election.

Which of the following statements, if true, would most support the argument in the passage?

A. The number of voters in Country X's next election will be significantly larger than the number of voters in the last election.

B. The Conservative Party will win the next election.

C. For each person interviewed in telephone polls before the next election, pollsters will be able to reasonably determine the likelihood of that person voting.

D. People who expressed no party preference during the in-person interviews shortly before Country X's last election did not outnumber the people who expressed a preference for the Conservative Party.

E. In the next election, pollsters will be able to conduct more in-person interviews than telephone interviews.

621. A company that manufactures plastic products from recyclable plastic is, surprisingly, unconcerned that economic conditions may worsen, despite analysts' belief that consumers would then consider ecofriendly plastic products an expensive luxury. But the company reasons that it will be able to lower its prices because, in a weakened economy, other ecofriendly plastic manufacturers are likely to fail. Demand among manufacturers for recyclable plastics as raw materials would then plummet, creating an oversupply of such materials, making them less expensive for the manufacturer to purchase and thus lowering the company's costs.

Which of the following, if true, most weakens the company's reasoning?

A. Smaller ecofriendly plastic manufacturers are more likely to fail in a weakened economy than larger ecofriendly manufacturers are.

B. Some retailers whose sales include various companies' ecofriendly plastic products have struggled in recent years despite the overall good economy.

C. Consumers would likely soon learn of the oversupply of recyclable plastics and cease recycling them, significantly raising manufacturers' raw-material costs.

D. Retailers, including retailers that cater to consumers seeking certain types of ecofriendly products, may lose some business if economic conditions worsen.

E. The plastics used by the company in its products were, after a recent investigation by a regulatory body, declared to be safe for consumers.

622. Researchers asked volunteers to imagine they were running a five-kilometer race against 50 people and then against 500 people, races in each of which the top 10 percent would receive a $1,000 prize. Asked about the effort they would apply in the respective cases, the volunteers indicated, on average, that they would run slower in the race against the greater number of people. A likely explanation of this result is that those of the volunteers who were most *comparatively inclined*—those who most tended to compare themselves with others in the social environment—determined (perhaps unconsciously) that extreme effort would not be worthwhile in the 500-competitor race.

Which of the following would, if known to be true, most help justify the explanation offered above?

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A. The volunteers who were most comparatively inclined were also those who had the greatest desire to win a $1,000 prize.

B. The volunteers who were the least comparatively inclined had no greater desire to win the $1,000 than those who were the most comparatively inclined.

C. The volunteers who were most comparatively inclined were likely to indicate that they would run the two races at the same speed.

D. The most comparatively inclined volunteers believed that they were significantly less likely to finish in the top 10 percent in the race against 500 than in the race against 50.

E. Volunteers were chosen for participation in the study on the basis of answers to various questions designed to measure the degree to which the volunteers were comparatively inclined.

623. According to a study, after a week of high-altitude living, twenty men had slimmed down. The men, middle-aged residents of low-altitude areas, had been taken to a research station at 2,650 meters (8,694 feet) above sea level. They had unrestricted access to food and were forbidden vigorous exercise, yet they lost an average of 1.5 kilograms (3.3 pounds) during their one-week stay. Clearly, the lower availability of oxygen at higher altitudes, or hypobaric hypoxia, can be said to have caused the weight loss, since _____.

Which of the following would, if true, most logically complete the argument?

A. a decrease in oxygen intake has been shown to depress appetite

B. the men all participated in the same kinds of exercise during their stay

C. the foods available to the men had fewer calories than the foods they usually ate

D. exercise at higher altitudes is more difficult than exercise at lower altitudes is

E. several weeks after returning home, the men still weighed less than they had before the study

624. Editorial: Our city's public transportation agency is facing a budget shortfall. The fastest-growing part of the budget has been employee retirement benefits, which are exceptionally generous. Unless the budget shortfall is resolved, transportation service will be cut, and many transportation employees will lose their jobs. Thus, it would be in the employees' best interest for their union to accept cuts in retirement benefits.

Which of the following is an assumption the editorial's argument requires?

A. The transportation employees' union should not accept cuts in retirement benefits if doing so would not be in the employees' best interest.

B. The only feasible way for the agency to resolve the budget shortfall would involve cutting transportation service and eliminating jobs.

C. Other things being equal, it is in the transportation employees' interest to have exceptionally generous retirement benefits.

D. Cutting the retirement benefits would help resolve the agency's budget shortfall.

E. The transportation employees' union will not accept cuts in retirement benefits if doing so will not allow more transportation employees to keep their jobs.

625. Researchers hope to find clues about the A'mk peoples who lived in the Kaumpta region about one thousand years ago but who left few obvious traces. The researchers plan to hire the few remaining shamans of the modern-day indigenous people in Kaumpta, who are believed to be descended from the A'mk, to lead them to ancestral sites that may be the remains of A'mk buildings or ceremonial spaces. The shamans were taught the location of such sites as part of their traditional training as youths, and their knowledge of traditional Kaumpta customs may help determine the nature of any sites the researchers find.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the success of the plan depends?

A. The researchers have reliable evidence that the A'mk of one thousand years ago built important ceremonial spaces.

B. The shamans have a reasonably accurate memory of A'mk sites they learned about as youths.

C. Kaumpta shamans are generally held in high esteem for their traditional knowledge.

D. Modern technologies available to the researchers are likely to be able to find some A'mk sites easily.

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E. Most or all A'mk sites are likely to be found within the Kaumpta region.

626. Astronomer: Most stars are born in groups of thousands, each star in a group forming from the same parent cloud of gas. Each cloud has a unique, homogeneous chemical composition. Therefore, whenever two stars have the same chemical composition as each other, they must have originated from the same cloud of gas.

Which of the following, if true, would most strengthen the astronomer's argument?

A. In some groups of stars, not every star originated from the same parent cloud of gas.

B. Clouds of gas of similar or identical chemical composition may be remote from each other.

C. Whenever a star forms, it inherits the chemical composition of its parent cloud of gas.

D. Many stars in vastly different parts of the universe are quite similar in their chemical compositions.

E. Astronomers can at least sometimes precisely determine whether a star has the same chemical composition as its parent cloud of gas.

627. With employer-paid training, workers have the potential to become more productive not only in their present employment but also in any number of jobs with different employers. To increase the productivity of their workforce, many firms are planning to maintain or even increase their investments in worker training. But some training experts object that if a trained worker is hired away by another firm, the employer that paid for the training has merely subsidized a competitor. They note that such hiring has been on the rise in recent years.

Which of the following would, if true, contribute most to defeating the training experts' objection to the firms' strategy?

A. Firms that promise opportunities for advancement to their employees get, on average, somewhat larger numbers of job applications from untrained workers than do firms that make no such promise.

B. In many industries, employees who take continuing-education courses are more competitive in the job market.

C. More and more educational and training institutions are offering reduced tuition fees to firms that subsidize worker training.

D. Research shows that workers whose training is wholly or partially subsidized by their employer tend to get at least as much training as do workers who pay for all their own training.

E. For most firms that invest in training their employees, the value added by that investment in employees who stay exceeds the value lost through other employees' leaving to work for other companies.

628. In emerging economies in Africa and other regions, large foreign banks that were set up during the colonial era have long played a major economic role. These institutions have tended to confine their business to the wealthier of banks' potential customers. But development of these countries' economies requires financing of the small businesses that dominate their manufacturing, farming, and services sectors. So economic growth will be likely to occur if local banks take on this portion of the financial services markets, since _____.

Which of the following completions would produce the strongest argument?

A. local banks tend not to strive as much as large foreign banks to diversify their investments

B. small farming and manufacturing businesses contribute to economic growth if they obtain adequate investment capital

C. large foreign banks in emerging economies could, with local employees and appropriate local consultation, profitably expand their business to less wealthy clients

D. some small businesses are among the wealthier customers of foreign banks in emerging economies

E. local banks in emerging economies tend to be less risk-averse than foreign banks

629. Exporters in Country X are facing lower revenues due to a shortage of the large metal shipping containers in which they send their goods by sea to other countries. Fewer containers arrive in Country X due to reductions in imports. This has meant lost orders, costly delays, and a scramble for alternatives, such as air freight, all of which are costlier. Moreover, the revenues of exporters in Country X will probably continue to decline in the near future. This is because other countries are likely to find it increasingly unprofitable to export their goods to Country X, and because _____.

Which of the following would most logically complete the passage?

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Which of the following would most logically complete the passage?

A. production of shipping containers in Country X is growing rapidly as a response to the shortage

B. shipping companies are willing to move containers from country to country only when the containers are full

C. the cost of shipping alternatives such as air freight is likely to stabilize in the near future

D. consumers in Country X are purchasing more products than ever before

E. the worldwide demand for goods made in Country X has only recently begun to rise after a long decline

630. Candle Corporation's television stations are likely to have more income from advertisers than previously. This is because advertisers prefer to reach people in the 18- to 49-year-old age group and the number of people in that group watching Candle television is increasing. Furthermore, among Candle viewers, the percentage of viewers 18 to 49 years old is increasing.

Which of the following, if true, would most strengthen the argument that Candle Corporation will receive more income from advertisers?

A. Advertisers carefully monitor the demographic characteristics of television audiences and purchase advertising time to reach the audiences they prefer to reach.

B. Among people over 49 years old, fewer viewers of Candle stations buy products advertised on television than do viewers of other stations.

C. There will be increasingly more advertisements on television that are directed at viewers who are over 49 years old.

D. Candle stations plan to show reruns of television shows during hours when other stations run shows for the first time.

E. People 18 to 49 years old generally have less disposable income to spend than do people over 49 years old.

631. In order to reduce the number of items damaged while in transit to customers, packaging consultants recommended the TrueSave mail-order company increase the amount of packing material so as to fill any empty spaces in its cartons. Accordingly, TrueSave officials instructed the company's packers to use more packing material than before, and the packers zealously acted on these instructions and used as much as they could. Nevertheless, customer reports of damaged items rose somewhat.

Which of the following, if true, most helps to explain why acting on the consultants' recommendation failed to achieve its goal?

A. The change in packing policy led to an increase in expenditure on packing material and labor.

B. When packing material is compressed too densely, it loses some of its capacity to absorb shock.

C. The amount of packing material used in a carton does not significantly influence the ease with which a customer can unpack the package.

D. Most of the goods TrueSave ships are electronic products that are highly vulnerable to being damaged in transit.

E. TrueSave has lost some of its regular customers as a result of the high number of damaged items they received.

632. An unusually severe winter occurred in Europe after the continent was blanketed by a blue haze resulting from the eruption of the Laki Volcano in the European republic of Iceland in the summer of 1984. Thus, it is evident that major eruptions cause the atmosphere to become cooler than it would be otherwise.

Which of the following statements, if true, most seriously weakens the argument above?

A. The cooling effect triggered by volcanic eruptions in 1985 was counteracted by an unusual warming of Pacific waters.

B. There is a strong statistical link between volcanic eruptions and the severity of the rainy season in India.

C. A few months after El Chichón's large eruption in April 1982, air temperatures throughout the region remained higher than expected given the long-term weather trends.

D. The climatic effects of major volcanic eruptions can temporarily mask the general warming trend resulting from an excess of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere.

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from an excess of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere.

E. Three months after an early springtime eruption in South America during the late nineteenth century, sea surface temperatures near the coast began to fall.

633. Political theorist: Even with the best spies, area experts, and satellite surveillance, foreign policy assessments can still lack important information. In such circumstances intuitive judgment is vital. A national leader with such judgment can make good decisions about foreign policy even when current information is incomplete, since _____.

Which of the following, if true, most logically completes the argument?

A. the central reason for failure in foreign policy decision making is the absence of critical information

B. those leaders whose foreign policy decisions have been highly ranked have also been found to have good intuitive judgment

C. both intuitive judgment and good information are required for sound decision-making

D. good foreign policy decisions often lead to improved methods of gathering information

E. intuitive judgment can produce good decisions based on past experience, even when there are important gaps in current information

634. Supply shortages and signs of growing demand are driving cocoa prices upward. Unusually severe weather in cocoa-producing regions—too much rain in Brazil and too little in West Africa—has limited production. Further, Europe and North America recently reported stronger demand for cocoa. In the first quarter, grinding of cocoa beans—the first stage in processing cocoa for chocolate—rose 8.1 percent in Europe and 16 percent in North America. Analysts have concluded that cocoa's price will continue to rise at least into the near future.

Which of the following would, if true, most strengthen the reasoning above?

A. Ground cocoa beans can be stored for long periods before they spoil.

B. Several European and North American manufacturers that use cocoa have recently improved their processing capacity.

C. It takes new cocoa trees five or six years before they start bearing fruit.

D. Governments in Europe and North America are likely to change current restrictions on cocoa imports.

E. Historically, cocoa production has varied widely from year to year.

635. During the earliest period of industrialization in Britain, steam engines were more expensive to build and operate than either windmills or water mills, the other practicable sources of power for factories. Yet despite their significant cost disadvantage, steam-powered factories were built in large numbers well before technical improvements brought their cost down. Furthermore, they were built even in regions where geographical conditions permitted the construction of wind- and water-powered factories close to major markets.

Which of the following, if true, most helps to explain the proliferation of steam-powered factories during the earliest period of industrialization in Britain?

A. In many areas of Britain, there were fewer steam-powered factories than wind- or water-powered factories in the earliest period of industrialization.

B. Unlike wind- or water-powered factories, steam-powered factories were fueled with coal, which sometimes had to be transported significant distances from the mine to the site of the factory.

C. It was both difficult and expensive to convert a factory from wind power or water power to steam power.

D. In the early period of industrialization, many goods sold in towns and cities could not be mass-produced in factories.

E. In Britain, the number of sites where a wind- or water-powered factory could be built was insufficient to provide for all of the demand for factory-produced goods at the time.

636. A popular beach has long had a dolphin-feeding program in which fish are given to dolphins several times a day. Many dolphins get as much as half of their food each day there. Although dolphins that first benefit from the program as adults are healthy and long-lived, their offspring have a lower life expectancy than offspring of dolphins that feed exclusively in the wild.

Which of the following, if true, most helps to explain the lower life expectancy of offspring of dolphins feeding at the beach compared to other young dolphins?

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at the beach compared to other young dolphins?

A. Sharks that prey on dolphins are less common in the open seas off the beach than in many other areas of the open seas where dolphins congregate.

B. Many of the adult dolphins that feed at the beach are females that nurse their offspring there.

C. The fish given to the dolphins at the beach are the same types of fish that dolphins typically catch in the wild.

D. Many dolphins that feed at the beach with their offspring come to the beach only a few times a month.

E. Adult dolphins that feed at the beach spend much less time teaching their offspring how to catch fish in the wild than do other adult dolphins.

637. **Plant scientists have used genetic engineering on seeds to produce crop plants that are highly resistant to insect damage.** Unfortunately, the seeds themselves are quite expensive, and the plants require more fertilizer and water to grow well than normal ones. Accordingly, **for most farmers the savings on pesticides would not compensate for the higher seed costs and the cost of additional fertilizer.** However, since consumer demand for grains, fruits, and vegetables grown without the use of pesticides continues to rise, the use of genetically engineered seeds of this kind is likely to become widespread.

In the argument given, the two portions in **boldface** play which of the following roles?

A. The first supplies a context for the argument; the second is the argument's main conclusion.

B. The first introduces a development that the argument predicts will have a certain outcome; the second is a state of affairs that, according to the argument, contributes to bringing about that outcome.

C. The first presents a development that the argument predicts will have a certain outcome; the second acknowledges a consideration that tends to weigh against that prediction.

D. The first provides evidence to support a prediction that the argument seeks to defend; the second is that prediction.

E. The first and the second each provide evidence to support the argument's main conclusion.

638. Which of the following most logically completes the passage?

Leptin, a protein occurring naturally in the blood, appears to regulate how much fat the body carries by speeding up the metabolism and decreasing the appetite when the body has too much fat. Mice that do not naturally produce leptin have more fat than other mice, but they lose fat rapidly when they are given leptin injections. Unfortunately, however, leptin cannot be used as a dietary supplement to control fat, since _____.

A. the digestive system breaks down proteins before they can enter the bloodstream

B. there are pharmaceuticals already available that can contribute to weight loss by speeding up the metabolism

C. people with unusually low levels of leptin in their blood tend to have a high percentage of body fat

D. the mice that do not naturally produce leptin were from a specially bred strain of mice

E. mice whose bodies did produce leptin also lost some of their body fat when given leptin injections

639. Large national budget deficits do not cause large trade deficits. If they did, countries with the largest budget deficits would also have the largest trade deficits. In fact, when deficit figures are adjusted so different countries are reliably comparable to each other, there is no such correlation.

If the statements above are all true, which of the following can properly be inferred on the basis of them?

A. Countries with large national budget deficits tend to restrict foreign trade.

B. Reliable comparisons of the deficit figures of one country with those of another are impossible.

C. Reducing a country's national budget deficit will not necessarily result in a lowering of any trade deficit that country may have.

D. When countries are ordered from largest to smallest in terms of population, the smallest countries generally have the smallest budget and trade deficits.

E. Countries with the largest trade deficits never have similarly large national budget deficits.

640. Archaeologists use technology to analyze ancient sites. It is likely that this technology will advance considerably

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640. Archaeologists use technology to analyze ancient sites. It is likely that this technology will advance considerably in the near future, allowing archaeologists to gather more information than is currently possible. If they study certain sites now, they risk contaminating or compromising them for future studies. Therefore, in order to maximize the potential for gathering knowledge in the long run, a team of archaeologists plans to delay the examination of a newly excavated site.

Which of the following would be most useful to investigate for the purpose of evaluating the plan's prospects for achieving its goal?

A. Whether any of the contents of the site will significantly deteriorate before the anticipated technology is available

B. Whether there will continue to be improvements on the relevant technology

C. Whether the team can study a site other than the newly excavated site for the time being

D. Whether the site was inhabited by a very ancient culture

E. Whether the anticipated technology will damage objects under study

641. More and more law firms specializing in corporate taxes are paid on a contingency-fee basis. Under this arrangement, if a case is won, the firm usually receives more than it would have received if it had been paid on the alternate hourly rate basis. If the case is lost, the firm receives nothing. Most firms are likely to make more under the contingency-fee arrangement.

Which of the following, if true, would most strengthen the prediction above?

A. Firms that work exclusively under the hourly rate arrangement spend, on average, fewer hours on cases that are won than on cases that are lost.

B. Some litigation can last for years before any decision is reached, and, even then, the decision may be appealed.

C. Firms under the contingency-fee arrangement still pay their employees on an hourly basis.

D. Since the majority of firms specialize in certain kinds of cases, they are able to assess accurately their chances of winning each potential case.

E. Firms working under the contingency-fee arrangement take in fewer cases per year than do firms working under the hourly rate arrangement.

642. Pretzel vendor: The new license fee for operating a pretzel stand outside the art museum is prohibitively expensive. Charging typical prices, I would need to sell an average of 25 pretzels per hour to break even. At my stand outside City Hall, with about as many passers-by as at the art museum, I average only 15 per hour. So I could not break even running a stand outside the art museum, much less turn a profit.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the pretzel vendor's argument?

A. The pretzel vendor does not sell anything other than pretzels.

B. People who visit the art museum are more likely to buy pretzels than are people who go to City Hall.

C. The license fee for operating a pretzel stand outside City Hall will not increase.

D. People who buy pretzels at pretzel stands are more likely to do so during the lunch hour than at other times.

E. The city will grant more licenses for pretzel stands outside the art museum than the number it grants for stands outside City Hall.

643. Beginning in 1966, all new cars sold in Morodia were required to have safety belts and power steering. Previously, most cars in Morodia were without these features. Safety belts help to prevent injuries in collisions, and power steering helps to avoid collisions in the first place. But even though in 1966 one-seventh of the cars in Morodia were replaced with new cars, the number of car collisions and collision-related injuries did not decline.

Which of the following, if true about Morodia, most helps to explain why the number of collisions and collision-related injuries in Morodia failed to decline in 1966?

A. Because of a driver-education campaign, most drivers and passengers in cars that did have safety belts used them in 1966.

B. Most of the new cars bought in 1966 were bought in the months of January and February.

C. In 1965, substantially more than one-seventh of the cars in Morodia were replaced with new cars.

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C. In 1965, substantially more than one-seventh of the cars in Morodia were replaced with new cars.

D. An excessive reliance on the new safety features led many owners of new cars to drive less cautiously in 1966 than before.

E. The seat belts and power steering put into new cars sold in 1966 had to undergo strict quality-control inspections by manufacturers, whether the cars were manufactured in Morodia or not.

644. Manufacturers of mechanical pencils make most of their profit on pencil leads rather than on the pencils themselves. The Write Company, which cannot sell its leads as cheaply as other manufacturers can, plans to alter the design of its mechanical pencil so that it will accept only a newly designed Write Company lead, which will be sold at the same price as the Write Company's current lead.

Which of the following, if true, most strongly supports the Write Company's projection that its plan will lead to an increase in its sales of pencil leads?

A. The new Write Company pencil will be introduced at a price higher than the price the Write Company charges for its current model.

B. In the foreseeable future, manufacturers of mechanical pencils will probably have to raise the prices they charge for mechanical pencils.

C. The newly designed Write Company lead will cost somewhat more to manufacture than the Write Company's current lead does.

D. A rival manufacturer recently announced similar plans to introduce a mechanical pencil that would accept only the leads produced by that manufacturer.

E. In extensive test marketing, mechanical-pencil users found the new Write Company pencil markedly superior to other mechanical pencils they had used.

645. Enterprise Bank currently requires customers with checking accounts to maintain a minimum balance or pay a monthly fee. Enterprise plans to offer accounts with no monthly fee and no minimum-balance requirement; to cover their projected administrative costs of $3 per account per month, they plan to charge $30 for overdrawing an account. Since each month on average slightly more than 10 percent of Enterprise's customers overdraw their accounts, bank officials predict the new accounts will generate a profit.

Which of the following, if true, most strongly supports the bank officials' prediction?

A. Some of Enterprise Bank's current checking account customers are expected to switch to the new accounts once they are offered.

B. One-third of Enterprise Bank's revenues are currently derived from monthly fees tied to checking accounts.

C. Many checking account customers who occasionally pay a fee for not maintaining a minimum balance in their account generally maintain a balance well above the minimum.

D. Customers whose checking accounts do not have a minimum-balance requirement are more likely than others to overdraw their checking accounts.

E. Customers whose checking accounts do not have a minimum-balance requirement are more likely than others to write checks for small amounts.

646. Highway official: When resurfacing our concrete bridges, we should use electrically conductive concrete (ECC) rather than standard concrete. In the winter, ECC can be heated by passing an electric current through it, thereby preventing ice buildup. The cost of the electricity needed is substantially lower than the cost of the deicing salt we currently use.

Taxpayer: But ECC is vastly more expensive than standard concrete, so your proposal is probably not justifiable on economic grounds.

Which of the following, if true, could best be used by the highway official to support the official's proposal in the face of the taxpayer's objection?

A. The use of deicing salt causes corrosion of reinforcing steel in concrete bridge decks and damage to the concrete itself, thereby considerably shortening the useful life of concrete bridges.

B. Severe icing conditions can cause power outages and slow down the work of emergency crews trying to get power restored.

C. In weather conditions conducive to icing, ice generally forms on the concrete surfaces of bridges well

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before it forms on parts of the roadway that go over solid ground.

D. Aside from its potential use for deicing bridges, ECC might also be an effective means of keeping other concrete structures such as parking garages and airport runways ice free.

E. If ECC were to be used for a bridge surface, the electric current would be turned on only at times at which ice was likely to form.

647. In virtually any industry, technological improvements increase labor productivity, which is the output of goods and services per person-hour worked. In Parland's industries, labor productivity is significantly higher than it is in Vergia's industries. Clearly, therefore, Parland's industries must, on the whole, be further advanced technologically than Vergia's are. The argument is most vulnerable to which of the following criticisms?

A. It offers a conclusion that is no more than a paraphrase of one of the pieces of information provided in its support.

B. It presents as evidence in support of a claim information that is inconsistent with other evidence presented in support of the same claim.

C. It takes one possible cause of a condition to be the actual cause of that condition without considering any other possible causes.

D. It takes a condition to be the effect of something that happened only after the condition already existed.

E. It makes a distinction that presupposes the truth of the conclusion that is to be established.

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